

Katherine Van Koevering

Data Science and AI Institute
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Curriculum Vitae

Education

- 2025 – present **Postdoctoral Fellow**, *Johns Hopkins University*, Data Science and AI Institute, Baltimore.
Supervised by Anjalie Field
- 2018–2025 **PhD, Computer Science**, *Cornell University*, Ithaca.
Supervised by Jon Kleinberg
- 2014–2018 **BSc, Computer Science**, *University of Washington*, Seattle.
Data Science Concentration, Magna Cum Laude
- 2014–2018 **BSc, Statistics**, *University of Washington*, Seattle.
Magna Cum Laude

Publications

Peer-Reviewed

- 2027 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Yuanhao Liu, and Jon Kleinberg. The bureaucratization of the internet: Analyzing the diffusion of governance regimes on reddit (2011–2023). In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, 2027.
- 2026 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Yiquan Hong*, and Jon Kleinberg. Social tectonics: Rapid organization of online COVID communities. *PLOS ONE*, volume 21, page e0355369, 2026.
- 2026 **Van Koevering, Katherine** and Anjalie Field. It's how you ask: Gendered linguistic bias in llms. In *Proceedings of the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*, 2026.
- 2026 Jie Gao, Kaiser Sun, Jen-tse Huang, **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Sijie Ji, Heyuan Huang, Weiyan Shi, Zhuoran Lu, Ziang Xiao, Daniel Khashabi, and Mark Dredze. How to interpret agent behavior. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), Evaluations & Datasets Track*, 2026.
- 2021 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Austin Benson, and Jon Kleinberg. Random graphs with prescribed k-core sequences: A new null model for network analysis. In *Proceedings of the Web Conference 2021*, pages 367–378, 2021.
- 2020 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Austin R Benson, and Jon Kleinberg. Frozen binomials on the web: Word ordering and language conventions in online text. In *Proceedings of The Web Conference 2020*, pages 606–616, 2020.
- 2018 Kate Starbird, Ahmer Arif, Tom Wilson, **Katherine Van Koevering**, Katya Yefimova, and Daniel Scarnecchia. Ecosystem or echo-system? exploring content sharing across alternative media domains. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, volume 12, 2018.

Preprints and Non-Archival Presentations

- 2026 **Van Koevering, Katherine** and Jon Kleinberg. Heads, tails, and ai fails: LLMs, randomness, and human judgments. *Preprint*, arXiv:2406.00092, 2026.
- 2025 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Ashley Young*, Meryl Ye*, and Jon Kleinberg. Freezing and thawing of linguistic binomials. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrköping, Sweden, 2025.

- 2025 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Meryl Ye*, and Jon Kleinberg. What's in a niche? migration patterns in online communities. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrkoping, Sweden, 2025.
- 2025 **Van Koevering, Katherine**, Yiquan Hong*, and Jon Kleinberg. Social tectonics: Rapid organization of online communities. Poster presented at IC2S2, Norrkoping, Sweden, 2025.

*undergraduate collaborators

Experience

Research Experience

- Summer 2021 **Research Intern**, Microsoft Research, Dr. Jennifer Neville.
- Summer 2020 **Research Intern**, Microsoft Research, Dr. Julia Kiseleva.
- 2017 – 2018 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, University of Washington, Prof. Kate Starbird.
- 2015 – 2016 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, University of Washington, Prof. Richard Anderson.

Teaching Experience

- Spring 2023 **Instructor**, CS 4820, *Introduction to Analysis of Algorithms*, Cornell University.
Co-taught senior level algorithms course (450 students) with Eshan Chattopadhyay. Responsibilities included lectures, homeworks, managing course logistics, exams, office hours, etc.
- Spring 2022 **Teaching Assistant**, CS 1340, *Choices and Consequences in Computing*, Cornell University.
- Fall 2021 **Teaching Assistant**, CS 6850, *The Structure of Information Networks*, Cornell University.

Work Experience

- Summer 2017 **Software Engineering Intern**, Facebook.
- Summer 2016 **Software Engineering Intern**, Zillow.

Other Experience

- 2023 **Invited Talk**, Calvin University, Random graphs with prescribed k -core sequences.
- 2018 – 2025 **Artificial Intelligence, Policy, and Practice (AIPP)**, Member, Cornell University, Interdisciplinary initiative where computer scientists, lawyers, philosophers, and social scientists discuss the societal impacts of AI.

Service

Professional

- 2026 **Organizing Committee and Senior Area Chair**, *NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Interpreting Agent Behavior*, International Convention Centre, Sydney, Australia.
- Reviewer WWW, ICWSM, IC2S2, CSCW, FAccT

University and Community

- 2025 – present **AI in the News**, *Organizer*, Founded, manages, and curates weekly discussions for graduate students about AI and its interactions with our world outside of academia from legal developments to popular culture.
- 2022 – 2025 **Room Reservation Coordinator**, *Cornell Computer Science*, Volunteer. One of two people managing all ad-hoc room reservations in Gates Hall, including scheduling dissertation defenses.
- 2018 – 2021 **Secretary, Board Member**, *Computer Science Graduate Organization*, One of three leaders of the graduate student organization for computer science, leading efforts to manage TA overwork, food waste, and more.
- 2019 – 2020 **Organizer**, *Women in Computing Tea*, Cornell Computer Science.
- 2017 **Officer, Board Member**, *ACM-W*, UW Chapter.

Honors and Awards

- 2026 **JHU Postdoctoral Flash Talk Competition**, 1st Place.

- 2025 **Data Science and AI Institute Postdoctoral Fellowship**, *Johns Hopkins University*, Inaugural cohort, one of two fellows.
- 2024 **Outstanding Reviewer Award**, *The Web Conference (WWW 2024)*.
- 2017 **Phi Beta Kappa**, *Inducted 2017*.

Media Coverage

- 2026 **Forbes**, “*AI Can Make Women Sound Less Sophisticated. Here’s What To Avoid In Your Prompt*”, Interviewed about *It’s How You Ask* (COLM 2026).
- 2026 **HuffPost**, “*AI’s Gender Bias Could Be Making You Look Less Competent At Work*”, Coverage of *It’s How You Ask* (COLM 2026).
- 2024 **Cornell Graduate School**, “*Student Spotlight: Katherine Van Koevering*”.
- 2024 **SIGBOVIK**, “*An Abundance of Katherines: The Game Theory of Baby Naming*”, Humor paper for Carnegie Mellon’s annual joke conference, written with Katy Blumer, Kate Donahue, Katie Fritz, Kate Ivanovich, Katherine Lee, Katie Luo, and Cathy Meng; widely shared on social media.
- 2018 **The Seattle Times**, “*A UW professor argued that women don’t want to code. What do women computer scientists have to say?*”, Contributed essay on being a woman in computer science.